

4.2.Importance of Honesty Question

Q1.Fatema is a senior engineer at a well-known construction firm. Her team is responsible for inspecting safety standards on a new residential high-rise project. During one of the inspections, she finds that certain safety protocols have not been followed. These include substandard quality materials and missing structural reinforcements in some sections.

When she informs her manager, he asks her to "**tweak the report**" to make the site pass the inspection, explaining that delays would cost the company a major client and financial loss. He assures her that "it's a minor thing" and that the building is "probably safe enough."

Fatema is torn between obeying her manager and staying true to her professional ethics.

(a) Why is **honesty important** in this professional context, and what should Fatema do?

(b) Based on the scenario what would be your recommendation?

Q2. Rahman is a computer science student interning at a tech startup that develops a job recruitment platform. His team is responsible for maintaining the platform's AI-based candidate shortlisting algorithm.

While reviewing the code, Rahman discovers that the algorithm is **intentionally biased** — it lowers the ranking of applicants from certain universities and favors others. When he questions this, his team leader admits it's a "business decision" to impress high-paying clients who prefer candidates from specific schools. Rahman is asked to stay quiet and not document his findings.

Rahman knows that this practice is **unfair, discriminatory, and violates basic principles of transparency and ethical AI**.

(a) Why is **honesty important** in this professional computing context, and what should Rahman do?

(b)What will be your recommendation based on the context?

Q3. Nusrat is a software developer working for a tech company that has recently launched a new mobile health-tracking app. The app collects users' health data including sleep patterns, heart rate, and location.

Nusrat notices that although the app claims in its **privacy policy** that data is used **only for improving user experience**, the company is **silently sharing anonymized data with third-party advertisers**.

When she brings this up, her manager says, “We’re not doing anything illegal. Everyone does it. It’s just anonymized data — no harm done.” She’s also warned not to bring it up again or she might lose her job.

Nusrat knows that users trust the app with their personal health data and are unaware of the data sharing.

(a) Why is **transparency important** in computer science professional ethics, and what should Nusrat do?

(b) What is your recommendation based on the context?

Q4. Fahim is a final-year computer science student working on a capstone project in a team of four students. Each member is responsible for coding different modules, and they conduct peer reviews weekly to maintain code quality.

One of the team members, **Tuba**, is Fahim’s close friend. During a review session, Fahim discovers that Tuba’s code has serious logic flaws that could affect the project’s performance. However, since they are close friends and Tuba has been under stress due to personal reasons, Fahim is hesitant to criticize her work or suggest changes.

Instead of pointing out the issues in the group meeting, he gives her a “pass” and avoids detailed feedback.

Later, when the final project is submitted, the module Tuba worked on causes major bugs during the demo, affecting the entire team's grade.

(a) What conflict of interest did Fahim face, and what would have been the ethical way to handle the situation?

(b) What is your recommendation based on the context?